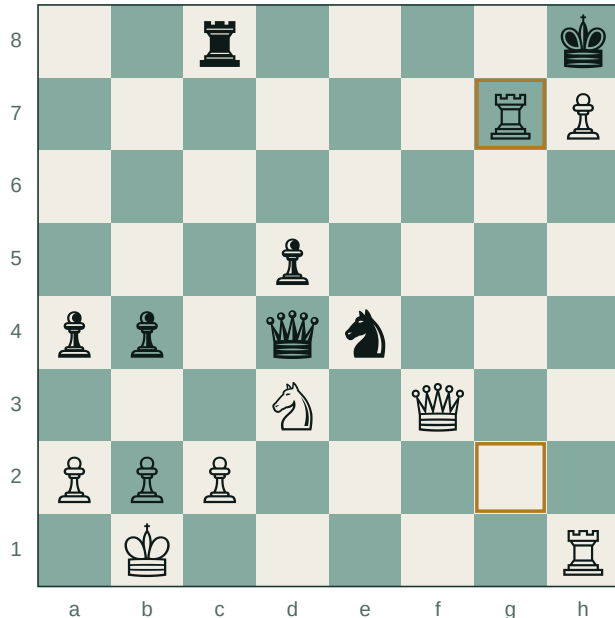


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 35

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Rxg7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Nd2+ 36. Ka1 Nxf3

35...Nd2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From d2 it attacks king on b1 and queen on f3. Recorded reply: **36.Ka1**.

36...Nxf3 The knight captures the queen on f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -6 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: rook on g7 and queen on f3. Check for tactical protection.